

TONE & TIGHTEN

FREE GUIDE

A WORKOUT AND FOOD GUIDE

TONE AND TIGHTEN

A workout and food guide for women who already train, and want the work to show.

8	8	12	1
WORKOUTS	WEEK SCHEDULE	RECIPES	GROCERY LIST

What Toning Actually Is

You already train and eat reasonably well. And two or three places on your body never seem to change, no matter how consistent you are.

You cannot choose where your body loses fat. Sit ups do not flatten a stomach, and inner thigh machines do not slim thighs. Spot reduction has been tested repeatedly and it does not happen. Any guide that sells you a workout for one body part is selling you something that does not exist.

So what is "toning" then? It is two things happening at once. **You build a little more muscle underneath, and you carry a little less over the top.** The muscle is what creates shape. The lower body fat is what lets you see it.

Training builds the shape. What you eat decides whether it shows. Doing one without the other is the single most common reason a consistent person stays stuck.

> **The one big idea:** shape comes from muscle. Train to build it, eat so it shows, and give it eight weeks.

The Four Levers

There are only four things that reliably change how your body looks, and you already have access to all of them.

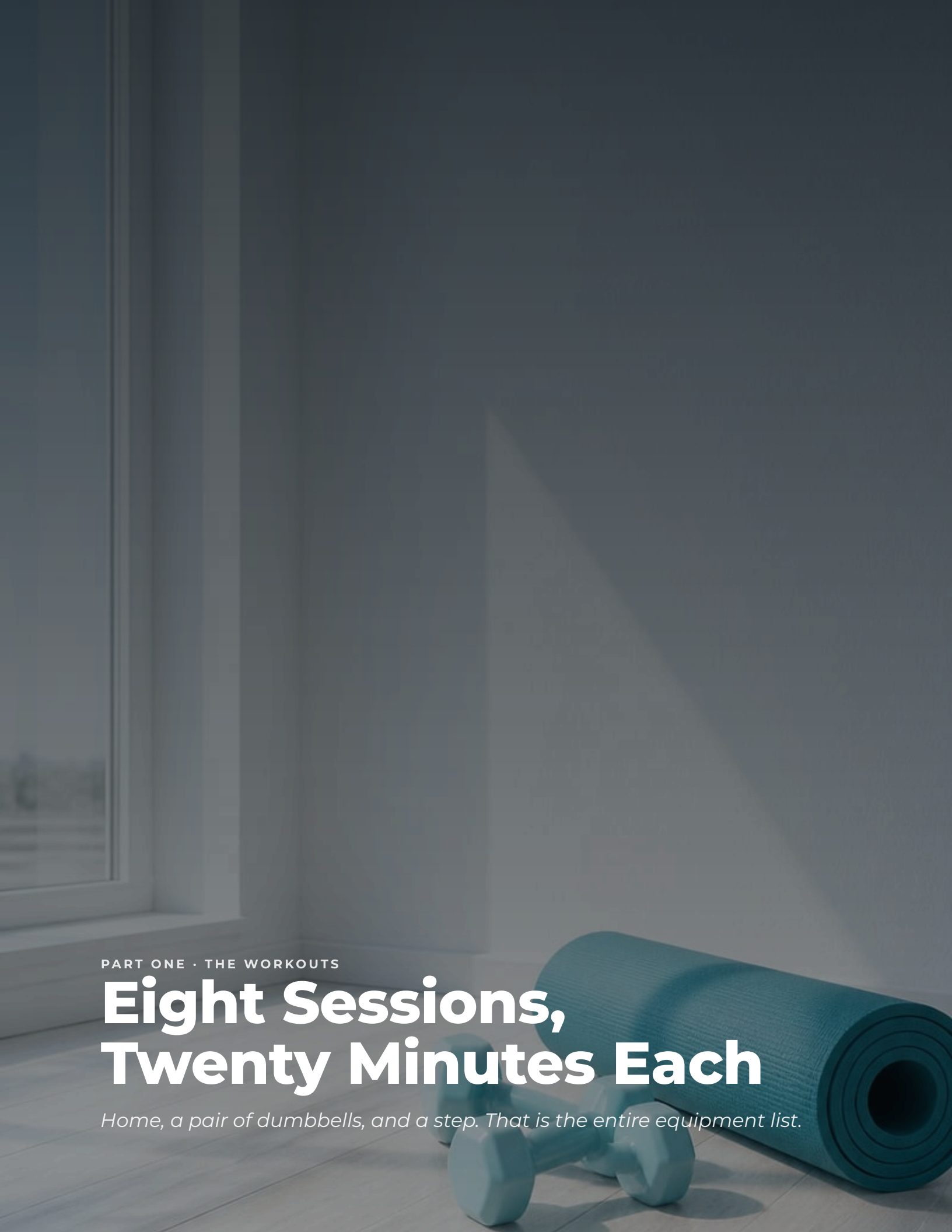
1. Resistance, done properly. Muscle changes shape when you ask it to do something hard and then ask it to do something slightly harder next time. Twenty minutes of hard work, three times a week.

2. Progressive overload. The same eight workouts done at the same weight for eight weeks will not change much. Each workout in here has a "make it harder" line, and using it is not optional.

3. Protein, at a level you are probably not hitting. Most active women eat less protein than they need to keep muscle while eating lighter. Every recipe in the back half of this guide is built around fixing that, and the target is on the food page.

4. Sleep and recovery. Muscle is built between sessions, not during them. Three hard sessions a week that you recover from will outperform five that you do not. If you are training every day and nothing is changing, this is usually why.

The rest of this guide is the workouts, the schedule and the food.



PART ONE · THE WORKOUTS

Eight Sessions, Twenty Minutes Each

Home, a pair of dumbbells, and a step. That is the entire equipment list.

The Workouts

W1 The Hinge and Bridge

FOUNDATION

Glutes, hamstrings, lower back.

The two movements that build the most shape through the hips, and the ones most people either skip or do badly. Everything else in this guide gets easier once these are strong.

Run it. 3 rounds. 10 dumbbell or bodyweight hip hinges, 12 glute bridges held two seconds at the top, 10 hinges again with a slower lowering. Rest 60 seconds between rounds.

Movements: 02 Hip Hinge, 03 Glute Bridge

Make it harder: Single leg glute bridges, or hold a dumbbell across your hips.

W2 Split Squat Standards

FOUNDATION

Quads, glutes, balance, one side at a time.

Training one leg at a time exposes the side that has been quietly doing less, and fixing that imbalance changes how you look standing still.

Run it. 3 rounds per leg. 8 split squats, 8 reverse lunges, 20 second hold at the bottom of a split squat. Rest 45 seconds, switch legs.

Movements: 04 Split Squat, 05 Reverse Lunge

Make it harder: Elevate the back foot, or hold a dumbbell in each hand.

W3 Row, Press, Repeat

FOUNDATION

Upper back, shoulders, arms, posture.

Shoulders and upper back are where "toned" reads fastest on a woman who already trains, and they are usually the least trained. Pulling twice for every push is what keeps the shape balanced.

Run it. 4 rounds. 10 bent over rows, 8 overhead presses, 10 rows again, 30 second rest. Keep the ribs down on the press.

Movements: 08 Bent Over Row, 09 Overhead Press

Make it harder: Slow the lowering to three seconds, or add weight to the rows first, the press second.

W4 The Core Brace

BUILD

Deep core, obliques, anti rotation.

No sit ups. The core's job is holding you still, so that's how this trains it. It won't burn stomach fat, and no exercise will.

Run it. 4 rounds. 30 second front plank, 20 second side plank each side, 10 slow dead bugs, 8 bird dogs each side. Rest 45 seconds.

Movements: 10 Front Plank, 11 Side Plank, 12 Dead Bug, 13 Bird Dog

Make it harder: Add a pause, then add a dumbbell held out in front on the dead bugs.

W5 Step Up Intervals

BUILD

Legs, glutes, heart rate.

The one session in here that gets you out of breath while still building the lower body. A stair or a sturdy chair is the whole equipment list.

Run it. 6 rounds. 40 seconds of step ups alternating legs, 20 seconds off. Then 3 rounds of 10 slow step downs per leg, controlled the whole way.

Movements: 06 Step Up, 07 Step Down

Make it harder: Raise the step, or hold dumbbells at your sides.

W6 The Full Body Twenty

BUILD

Everything, in one circuit.

For the week where you get one session. Every major movement pattern in twenty minutes, so nothing goes untrained even when the schedule collapses.

Run it. 5 rounds, 60 seconds rest between. 8 squats, 8 rows, 8 hip hinges, 6 presses, 30 second plank.

Movements: 01 Squat, 08 Bent Over Row, 02 Hip Hinge, 09 Overhead Press, 10 Front Plank

Make it harder: Cut the rest to 40 seconds before you add any weight.

W7 Density Day

ADVANCED

Full body, under time pressure.

Same work, less rest. This is how you keep progressing once adding weight every week stops being realistic.

Run it. Set a timer for 15 minutes. 6 squats, 6 rows, 6 presses, 6 hinges, as many rounds as you can while every rep still looks clean. Write the round count down.

Movements: 01 Squat, 08 Bent Over Row, 09 Overhead Press, 02 Hip Hinge

Make it harder: Beat last week's round count by one. That is the only progression this workout needs.

W8 The Ten Minute Finisher

TEN MINUTES

Glutes and core, no equipment.

The session for the day you are not going to train. Ten minutes, and it still counts.

Run it. 3 rounds, no rest inside a round. 15 glute bridges, 20 second side plank each side, 10 reverse lunges per leg, 30 second front plank.

Movements: 03 Glute Bridge, 11 Side Plank, 05 Reverse Lunge, 10 Front Plank

Make it harder: Add a fourth round. If you can do five, you are ready for W1 with weight.

How To Do Every Movement

Thirteen movements cover all eight workouts. **Read the cue even if you know the exercise.** It's the part most people get wrong.

There is no shame in the easier version. A movement done properly at half the range builds more than the full version done with a rounded back, and the range comes back quickly.

> **If it hurts, stop.** Muscles working hard is the point. Sharp pain in a joint is not, and no workout in this guide is worth training through it.

How To Do Every Movement

01 Squat

NOTHING, OR ONE DUMBBELL HELD AT YOUR CHEST

Also called: Bodyweight or goblet squat

SET UP

Feet a little wider than your hips, toes turned out slightly. If you are holding a dumbbell, hold one end in both hands against your chest with your elbows tucked in.

THE MOVEMENT

Push your hips back and bend your knees at the same time, and lower until your thighs are somewhere near parallel to the floor. Keep your whole foot on the ground. Stand back up by pushing the floor away, and finish standing tall rather than leaning back.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Knees track over your toes, not inward. If your knees fall in as you stand up, slow the whole rep down and go less deep.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Heels lifting off the floor, and depth taken from a rounded lower back rather than from the hips and knees. Go only as deep as you can with your back flat and your feet planted.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Thighs and glutes. Your back should feel braced, never strained.

MAKE IT EASIER

Sit down to a chair and stand straight back up, touching the seat each rep without resting on it.

02 Hip Hinge

DUMBBELLS OR NOTHING

Also called: Romanian deadlift, RDL

SET UP

Feet hip width. A soft bend in the knees, and that bend does not change for the whole rep. Dumbbells in front of your thighs, arms straight down.

THE MOVEMENT

Push your hips back toward the wall behind you and let your chest travel forward as a consequence, not as the action. The weights stay close to your legs the whole way. Stop when you feel a strong stretch up the back of your thighs, usually somewhere between your knee and mid shin. Drive your hips forward to stand up, and squeeze your glutes at the top.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Hips back, not chest down. If you think about lowering the weight you will round your back. Think about your hips travelling backward and the rest takes care of itself.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Turning it into a squat by bending the knees, or rounding the lower back to reach further down. Depth is not the goal here. The stretch is.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Hamstrings and glutes. If it is all lower back, your hips stopped moving.

MAKE IT EASIER

No weight, standing a few inches from a wall, tapping the wall with your hips on every rep.

03 Glute Bridge

NOTHING, OR ONE DUMBBELL ACROSS YOUR HIPS

SET UP

On your back, knees bent, feet flat and about hip width, heels close enough that your fingertips almost reach them. Arms down by your sides.

THE MOVEMENT

Push through your heels and lift your hips until your body makes a straight line from knees to shoulders. Squeeze your glutes hard at the top and hold for the count the workout asks for, then lower under control until your hips touch the floor.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Squeeze at the top, do not arch at the top. The lift comes from your glutes, and the moment it turns into a lower back arch you have gone too high.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Pushing through your toes, which turns it into a hamstring cramp, and rushing the lower half so the reps run together.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Glutes, and some hamstring. Not your lower back.

MAKE IT EASIER

Lift only as high as you can while keeping your ribs down, even if that is half the range. Range grows quickly here.

04 Split Squat

NOTHING, OR A DUMBBELL IN EACH HAND

SET UP

Stand in a long stride, one foot forward and one back, back heel off the floor. Feet stay about hip width apart side to side, not on a tightrope, or you will have nothing to balance on.

THE MOVEMENT

Lower straight down by bending both knees until your back knee is an inch or two off the floor, then drive up through your front foot. Your torso stays tall the whole time. Finish all the reps on one side before you swap.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Straight down, not forward. The movement is an elevator, not a lunge travelling across the room.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Drifting forward so all the work lands on the front knee, and letting the back foot creep in until you have no base.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

The front leg's thigh and glute. The back leg is there for balance, not for work.

MAKE IT EASIER

Hold a wall or a door frame with one hand. Balance is a skill and it arrives in about a week.

05 Reverse Lunge

NOTHING, OR A DUMBBELL IN EACH HAND

SET UP

Stand tall, feet hip width, weight even. If you are holding dumbbells, let them hang by your sides.

THE MOVEMENT

Step one foot straight back and lower until your back knee nearly touches the floor, keeping most of your weight on the front foot. Push through the front heel to step back to standing. Alternate legs, or do all the reps on one side if the workout says so.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Step back, not down. Reaching for the floor with the back foot is what keeps the front leg loaded and the front knee comfortable.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Short steps, which jam the front knee forward, and leaning the chest toward the front thigh.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Front leg's glute and thigh.

MAKE IT EASIER

Step back to a smaller depth, or hold a door frame with one hand while you learn the path.

06 Step Up

A STAIR, A STURDY CHAIR OR A BENCH. DUMBBELLS OPTIONAL

SET UP

Stand facing a step that puts your thigh roughly parallel to the floor when your foot is on it. Lower is fine. Wobbly is not, so test it before you load it.

THE MOVEMENT

Put your whole foot on the step, drive through that heel and stand up on top of the step. Step back down with the other foot, softly. Alternate legs, or run one side at a time.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Drive from the top foot, do not push off the bottom one. If the floor foot is doing the work, lower the step.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Pushing off the trailing toe to hop up, and dropping down so hard the step bangs.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

The leg on the step: glute and thigh.

MAKE IT EASIER

Use a lower step. A six inch stair done properly beats a bench done with a hop.

07 Step Down

A STAIR, A STURDY CHAIR OR A BENCH

SET UP

Stand on top of the step on one leg, the other foot hanging just off the edge, hands out in front for balance.

THE MOVEMENT

Bend the standing leg and lower the free foot slowly toward the floor. Tap your heel down without putting weight on it, then push back up to standing. Slow is the entire point: aim for three seconds down.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Control the lowering. This is the half of the movement that builds the leg, which is exactly the half most people drop.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Falling down to the floor and bouncing straight back up, and letting the standing knee collapse inward.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

The standing leg's thigh and glute, working hard on the way down.

MAKE IT EASIER

Use a lower step, and keep one hand on a wall until the wobble stops.

08 Bent Over Row

DUMBBELLS

SET UP

Hinge forward at the hips (movement 02) until your chest is roughly at forty five degrees, knees soft, back flat. Let the dumbbells hang straight down below your shoulders.

THE MOVEMENT

Pull both dumbbells toward your waist, leading with your elbows and keeping them close to your body. Squeeze your shoulder blades together at the top, then lower all the way until your arms are straight again.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Pull with your back, not your arms. Think about driving your elbows toward your back pockets, and let the hands come along for the ride.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Standing up a little more with every rep, and shrugging the shoulders up toward the ears instead of back.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Between and across your shoulder blades, and the back of your arms.

MAKE IT EASIER

Rest one hand on a chair and row one dumbbell at a time. It takes the lower back out of the job entirely.

09 Overhead Press

DUMBBELLS

SET UP

Stand tall, feet hip width, dumbbells at shoulder height with your palms facing forward and your elbows under your wrists. Squeeze your glutes and pull your ribs down so your back is not arched before you start.

THE MOVEMENT

Press both dumbbells straight up until your arms are locked out over your shoulders, biceps somewhere near your ears. Lower under control back to shoulder height.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Ribs down. Almost everyone leans back to get the weight up, and that turns a shoulder exercise into a lower back one.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Pressing forward rather than up, and bouncing the knees to help. If either is happening, the weight is too heavy.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Shoulders and the back of your arms.

MAKE IT EASIER

Press one arm at a time, or sit on a chair with your back against the backrest so leaning back is not an option.

10 Front Plank

NOTHING

SET UP

Forearms on the floor, elbows directly under your shoulders, feet about hip width. Body in one straight line from your head to your heels.

THE MOVEMENT

Hold. Squeeze your glutes, pull your ribs down toward your hips, and push the floor away with your forearms. Breathe normally the whole time rather than holding your breath.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> A plank is a squeeze, not a wait. If it feels like nothing after fifteen seconds you are resting in it rather than bracing.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Hips sagging toward the floor, or a backside pointed at the ceiling. Both are the body finding a way to stop working.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

The whole front of your middle, plus your glutes.

MAKE IT EASIER

Put your hands on a chair or a kitchen counter instead of the floor. Same shape, less load, and every bit of it counts.

11 Side Plank

NOTHING

SET UP

On your side, elbow under your shoulder, forearm flat on the floor, legs stacked. Top hand on your hip.

THE MOVEMENT

Lift your hips off the floor until your body is a straight line from shoulder to ankle, and hold for the count. Lower under control, then switch sides.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Push your bottom shoulder away from the floor. It stops you sinking into the joint and it turns the hold into work.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Hips drifting backward so it becomes a twist, and the top hip rolling forward.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Down the side of your middle, and the hip on the floor.

MAKE IT EASIER

Bend your knees and stack them, so the line runs from your shoulder to your knee. Every second still counts.

12 Dead Bug

NOTHING

SET UP

On your back, knees up over your hips at ninety degrees, arms straight up toward the ceiling. Press your lower back flat into the floor so there is no gap underneath it.

THE MOVEMENT

Lower one arm overhead and the opposite leg toward the floor at the same time, slowly, going only as far as you can while your lower back stays flat. Return to the start and switch sides. That is one rep.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> The rep ends the moment your lower back lifts off the floor. That point is your range, and it moves further out over the weeks.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Going fast, and going too far. An arching back means the core stopped working and your hip flexors took over, which is the opposite of the point.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Deep across the front of your stomach, holding still while your limbs move.

MAKE IT EASIER

Move the leg only and keep both arms up, until you can do ten without the back lifting.

13 Bird Dog

NOTHING

SET UP

On all fours, hands under shoulders, knees under hips, back flat like a tabletop. Look at the floor so your neck stays in line.

THE MOVEMENT

Reach one arm forward and the opposite leg straight back at the same time, until both are level with your body. Hold for a second, then come back and switch sides.

> **THE ONE CUE**
> Keep your hips level. If you imagine a glass of water balanced on your lower back, the whole exercise is not spilling it.

WHAT GOES WRONG

Lifting the leg higher than the hip, which arches the back, and rushing so the hips rock side to side.

WHERE YOU FEEL IT

Across your lower back and glutes, working to hold you still.

MAKE IT EASIER

Arm only, then leg only, then put them together.

The Eight Week Schedule

Three sessions a week. Never two hard days back to back. If you miss one, you do not make it up, you simply carry on with the next one in the list.

Weeks 1 and 2, learn the movements. Monday W1, Wednesday W3, Friday W5. Keep the weight light enough that the last rep of every set still looks like the first one. Write down what you used.

Weeks 3 to 5, add load. Monday W1, Wednesday W4, Friday W2, and swap in W6 for whichever one you like least. Each week, either add a little weight or add one rep per set to at least one movement. That is progressive overload.

Weeks 6 to 8, add density. Same workouts, shorter rests. W7 replaces one session a week. On a day when life wins, W8 takes ten minutes and still counts.

On the other days, walk.

> **Track two numbers only:** the weight you used and the reps you got. If neither has moved in three weeks, that is your signal to change something, and it is almost always the weight.



PART TWO · THE FOOD

Twelve High Protein Recipes

Built around protein, with the protein listed on every one.

The Food Half

Training builds the muscle. Food decides whether you see it. You do not need a diet, and there is no meal plan in this guide, because a meal plan is the thing everyone abandons in week two.

Aim for roughly 0.7 grams of protein per pound of your body weight per day. For a lot of women that lands somewhere between 100 and 140 grams. If you are eating half of that right now, which is common, closing that gap will do more for how you look than any change to your workouts.

Protein is doing two jobs here. It is the raw material for the muscle you are building, and it is far more filling per calorie than carbs or fat, so eating a bit less is easier.

The simple version: put a real protein at the centre of every meal, add a vegetable, and let the carbs be whatever is left. Every one of the twelve recipes that follows is built to that shape, and each one tells you the protein it delivers so you can stop guessing.

Two habits that cost nothing. Eat the protein on your plate before the starch. And drink enough water that you are not confusing thirst for hunger.

> This is general wellness information, not medical or nutritional advice, and it is not a weight loss program. Individual results vary. If you are pregnant, nursing, managing a condition or taking medication, talk to your healthcare provider before changing how you train or eat.



RECIPE 01 / 12

SERVES 2

Overnight Protein Oats

32 grams of protein before you leave the house. Made the night before, eaten cold.

380	**32g**	42g	9g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Rolled oats	1 cup
Plain Greek yogurt	1 cup
Milk of choice	1 cup
Vanilla or unflavoured protein powder	2 scoops
Chia seeds	2 tbsp
Berries	1 cup
Cinnamon	1 tsp

METHOD

1. Stir the oats, yogurt, milk, protein powder, chia and cinnamon together in a jar.
2. Seal and refrigerate overnight, or at least four hours.
3. Top with berries in the morning. Keeps three days.



RECIPE 02 / 12

SERVES 1

Cottage Cheese Berry Bowl

Two minutes and thirty grams of protein.

260	**30g**	18g	6g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Low fat cottage cheese	1 cup
Mixed berries	¾ cup
Ground flax	1 tbsp
Pistachios, chopped	1 tbsp
Cinnamon	a pinch
Honey, optional	1 tsp

METHOD

1. Spoon the cottage cheese into a bowl.
2. Pile the berries on top, scatter the flax and pistachios.
3. Dust with cinnamon and add the honey only if you want it.



RECIPE 03 / 12

SERVES 4

Sheet Pan Chicken And Greens

Four dinners from one tray. Cook it on the day you have the most time.

420	44g	22g	17g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Chicken thighs, boneless	2 lb
Broccoli, in florets	1 large head
Red onion, wedged	1
Bell peppers, sliced	2
Extra virgin olive oil	3 tbsp
Smoked paprika	2 tsp
Garlic, minced	4 cloves
Lemon	1
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 425F.
2. Toss everything except the lemon with the oil, paprika, garlic, salt and pepper.
3. Spread across one large tray in a single layer. Crowding it steams the vegetables instead of roasting them.
4. Roast 25 to 30 minutes, until the chicken is cooked through and the edges have colour.
5. Squeeze the lemon over the whole tray before serving.



RECIPE 04 / 12

SERVES 4

Salmon And Sweet Potato Tray

Protein and omega 3 fats in the same tray, with a carb that keeps you full. Cook the potatoes ahead and they finish in the time the salmon takes.

470	38g	34g	20g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Salmon fillets	4 (about 6 oz each)
Sweet potatoes, cubed	2 large
Asparagus, trimmed	1 bunch
Extra virgin olive oil	2 tbsp
Dijon mustard	1 tbsp
Lemon, zest and juice	1
Dill, chopped	2 tbsp
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400F. Toss the sweet potato in half the oil, roast 20 minutes.
2. Whisk the remaining oil with the mustard, lemon and dill.
3. Add the salmon and asparagus to the tray, spoon the dressing over the fish.
4. Roast a further 12 to 14 minutes, until the salmon flakes.



RECIPE 05 / 12

SERVES 4

Herbed Turkey Meatballs

Freezer friendly, and the fastest way to add real protein to a bowl of whatever you already have. Make a double batch, freeze half raw.

340	**36g**	12g	16g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Ground turkey	2 lb
Egg	1
Rolled oats, blitzed	½ cup
Parsley, chopped	¼ cup
Garlic, minced	3 cloves
Feta, crumbled	½ cup
Oregano	2 tsp
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400F and line a tray.
2. Mix everything gently. Overworking the mix makes the meatballs tight.
3. Roll into 20 balls and space them out on the tray.
4. Bake 18 to 20 minutes until cooked through.
5. Serve over greens, in a wrap, or on the barley bowl below.



RECIPE 06 / 12

SERVES 6

Chicken And White Bean Soup

Protein and soluble fiber in the same bowl, which is the combination that keeps you full longest. Better on day two.

310	**33g**	28g	7g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Chicken breast or thigh	1.5 lb
White beans, drained	2 cans
Onion, diced	1
Carrots, diced	3
Celery, diced	3 stalks
Garlic, minced	4 cloves
Chicken stock	8 cups
Kale, shredded	4 cups
Olive oil	1 tbsp
Thyme, salt, pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Soften the onion, carrot and celery in the oil for 8 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and thyme, then the stock and the chicken.
3. Simmer 20 minutes, lift the chicken out, shred it, return it to the pot.
4. Add the beans and kale, simmer 5 more minutes.



RECIPE 07 / 12

SERVES 4

Steak And Barley Bowl

Barley holds its texture for days where rice goes to paste, so this is the lunch that survives being made on Sunday.

480	40g	45g	16g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Lean steak	1.5 lb
Pearl barley	1.5 cups dry
Cucumber, diced	1
Cherry tomatoes, halved	2 cups
Red onion, thin sliced	½
Parsley, chopped	1 cup
Olive oil	3 tbsp
Lemon juice	3 tbsp
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Cook the barley to package directions, drain and cool.
2. Season the steak well and cook to your liking. Rest it 8 minutes before slicing, every time.
3. Toss the barley with the vegetables, parsley, oil and lemon.
4. Slice the steak across the grain and lay it over the top.



RECIPE 08 / 12 MAKES 12

Egg And Feta Breakfast Cups

Two of these is 18 grams of protein. They reheat in ninety seconds and keep four days.

110	9g	3g	7g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Eggs	10
Spinach, chopped	3 cups
Feta, crumbled	¾ cup
Bell pepper, small dice	1
Green onion, sliced	3
Milk	¼ cup
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F and oil a 12 hole muffin tin properly.
2. Whisk the eggs with the milk, salt and pepper.
3. Divide the vegetables and feta between the holes, pour the egg over.
4. Bake 20 to 22 minutes until set and just puffed.



RECIPE 09 / 12

SERVES 4

Shrimp And Quinoa Salad

Shrimp cooks in three minutes, and quinoa adds protein of its own.

390	35g	38g	11g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Shrimp, peeled	1.5 lb
Quinoa	1.5 cups dry
Avocado, diced	1
Cucumber, diced	1
Cilantro, chopped	1 cup
Lime, juice and zest	2
Olive oil	2 tbsp
Chili flakes	½ tsp

METHOD

1. Cook the quinoa, drain well and spread it out to cool.
2. Sear the shrimp in a hot pan, 90 seconds a side, no longer.
3. Whisk the lime, oil and chili flakes together.
4. Fold everything through the quinoa and eat warm or cold.



RECIPE 10 / 12

SERVES 2

Tuna Smash On Toast

Five minutes, thirty grams of protein, ingredients that live in the cupboard. This is the recipe for the day you were going to skip lunch.

350	**31g**	26g	13g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Tuna in water, drained	2 cans
Plain Greek yogurt	3 tbsp
Dijon mustard	1 tsp
Celery, fine dice	1 stalk
Red onion, fine dice	2 tbsp
Lemon juice	1 tbsp
Wholegrain bread	2 thick slices
Salt and pepper	to taste

METHOD

1. Smash the tuna with the yogurt, mustard and lemon.
2. Fold in the celery and onion, season well.
3. Toast the bread properly and pile it on.



RECIPE 11 / 12

SERVES 2

Greek Yogurt Protein Pudding

Thirty grams of protein, and it tastes like dessert.

240	**30g**	16g	5g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Plain Greek yogurt	1.5 cups
Chocolate or vanilla protein powder	1 scoop
Cocoa powder	1 tbsp
Vanilla extract	1 tsp
Milk, to loosen	2 tbsp
Raspberries	½ cup
Dark chocolate, grated	1 tsp

METHOD

1. Whisk the yogurt, protein powder, cocoa and vanilla until completely smooth.
2. Loosen with the milk a spoonful at a time.
3. Chill 20 minutes, then top with raspberries and the grated chocolate.



RECIPE 12 / 12

SERVES 1

Kefir Recovery Smoothie

For the twenty minutes after a session, when you are not hungry enough to eat but should be getting protein in anyway.

320	**33g**	34g	6g
CAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT

VALUES ARE APPROXIMATE, PER SERVING

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Plain kefir	1.5 cups
Protein powder	1 scoop
Frozen banana	1 small
Frozen berries	1 cup
Ground flax	1 tbsp
Spinach	a large handful

METHOD

1. Put the liquid in the blender first, then everything else.
2. Blend 45 seconds until completely smooth.
3. Drink it within the hour. It separates if it sits.

The Master Grocery List

Everything the twelve recipes need, grouped the way a shop is laid out.

Proteins: chicken thighs and breast, lean steak, ground turkey, salmon, shrimp, canned tuna, eggs

Dairy: plain Greek yogurt, low fat cottage cheese, kefir, feta, milk of choice

Pantry protein: whey or plant protein powder, vanilla and chocolate

Grains: rolled oats, pearl barley, quinoa, wholegrain bread

Legumes: white beans

Seeds and nuts: chia, ground flax, pistachios

Fruit: berries, bananas, lemons, limes, avocado

Vegetables: broccoli, asparagus, bell peppers, red onion, spinach, kale, celery, carrots, cucumber, cherry tomatoes, sweet potato, green onion

Good fats: extra virgin olive oil

Extras: Dijon mustard, smoked paprika, oregano, thyme, cinnamon, vanilla, garlic, fresh parsley, dill, cilantro, chili flakes, cocoa powder, dark chocolate, honey

The Fridge Door Cheat Sheet

Stick this where you will see it.

Every week:

- Three sessions, never two hard days back to back.
- Add a little weight, or one more rep, to at least one movement.
- Write down the weight and the reps.
- Walk on the days you do not train.

Every day:

- A real protein at every meal, aiming at 0.7g per pound of body weight.
- Protein on the plate before the starch.
- Water before you decide you are hungry.
- Seven hours of sleep, because that is when the muscle is actually built.

Ignore:

- Workouts sold as targeting one body part. You can't choose where fat comes off.
- The scale, day to day. Weigh weekly if at all, and judge the eight weeks on a photograph.

Make It Stick

You do not need all of this. Pick the three things below and make them automatic before you add anything else.

1. Three sessions a week, on the schedule, with the weight written down.
2. A real protein at every meal, aiming at the number on the food page.
3. Add either a little weight or one more rep, every single week.

Do that for eight weeks and then look at a photograph, not at the mirror and not at the scale. The scale moves for a dozen reasons. A photo shows the change.

Eight weeks is not long. It is two months of three short sessions a week.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Reach Back Out

Message the person who sent you this.

Tell them which workout you started with and what your protein number came out at, and they'll help you fit the schedule to your week.

Eight weeks is much easier with someone checking in.

The Small Print

This guide is general fitness and wellness information for educational purposes only. It is not medical, nutritional, diagnostic or treatment advice, and it is not a weight loss program.

We are not physicians, registered dietitians, physiotherapists or licensed healthcare providers. This content is not a substitute for professional advice.

Consult your physician or a qualified healthcare provider before beginning any exercise or nutrition program, especially if you are pregnant, nursing, have an injury or an existing medical condition, or take medication.

Individual results vary and no particular outcome is guaranteed. Stop any exercise that causes pain.

These statements have not been evaluated by the Food and Drug Administration. Nueva products are not intended to diagnose, treat, cure or prevent any disease.